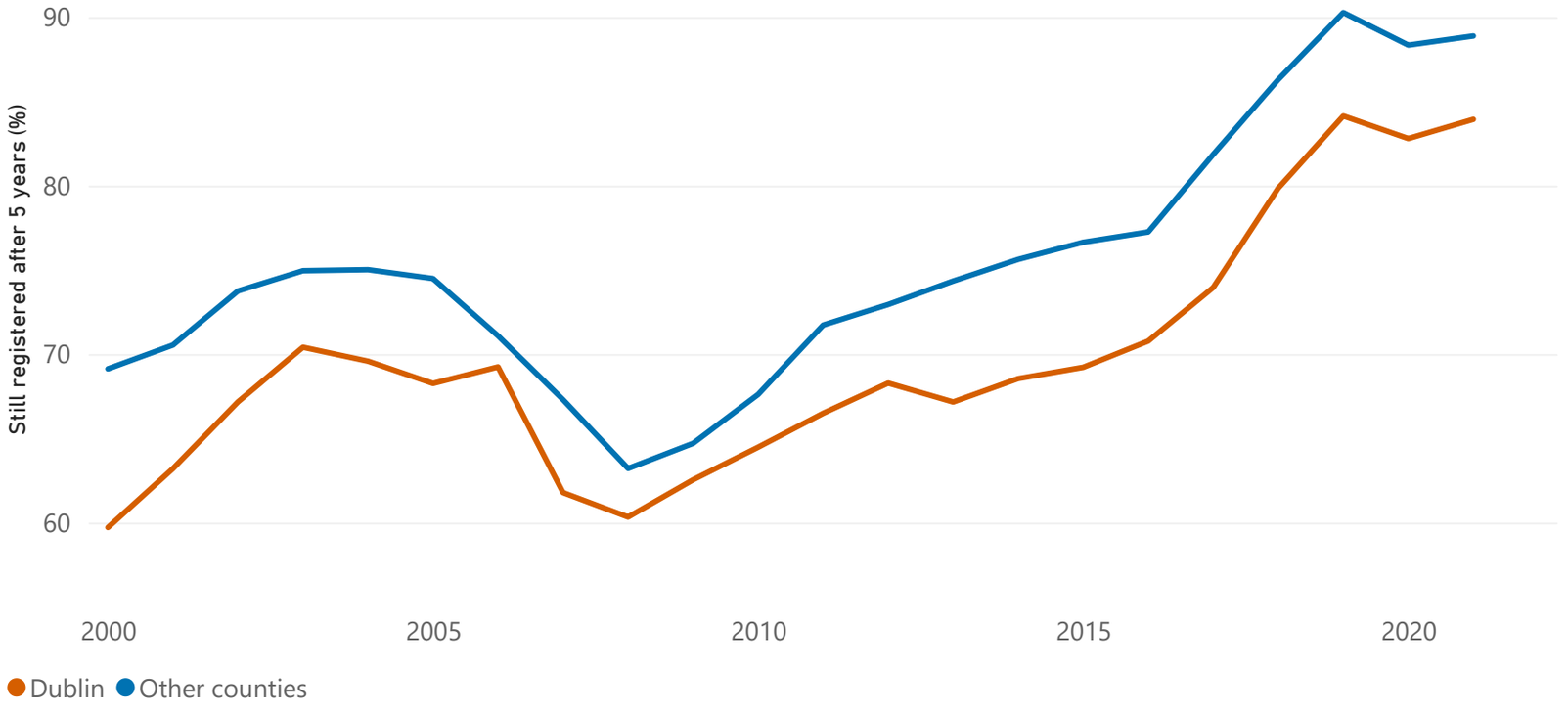
5-year survival by year registered: Dublin vs other counties



Which new Irish companies survive?

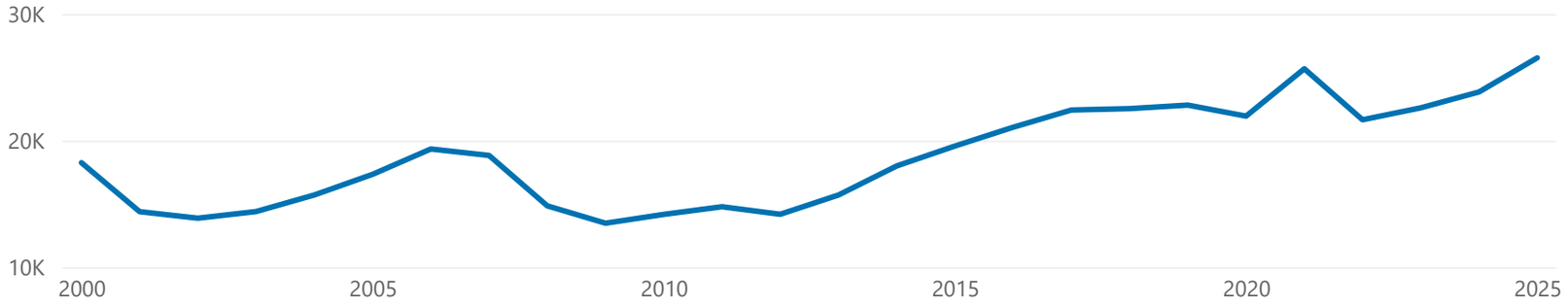
This page gives the big picture: how many companies were registered, and how many were still on the register 5 years later.

- Of companies registered in 2000 – 2021, 73.7% were still registered 5 years later.
- Dublin companies survive less: -5.5 points compared with companies in other counties.
- A model using sector, area and company type ranks companies only a little better than random guessing (AUC 0.610).
- Dublin is lower than other counties in every year on the chart.

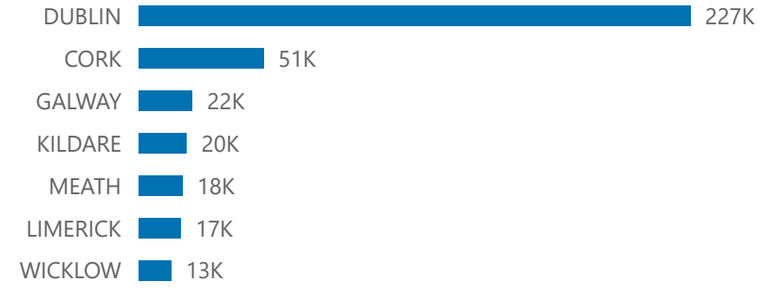
Source: CRO Company Records (opendata.cro.ie), CC BY 4.0.

Companies registered	5-year survival	Dublin vs other	Model AUC (test)
512,008	**73.7%**	**-5.5 points**	**0.610**

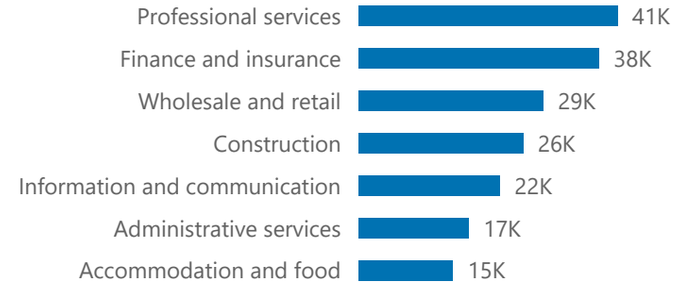
Companies registered per year



Companies registered since 2000 (top 7 counties)



Companies registered since 2016 (top 7 sectors)



Registered in Dublin

44.4%

Most in one year

26,533 (2025)

Fewest in one year

13,465 (2009)

Registered since 2016

255,343

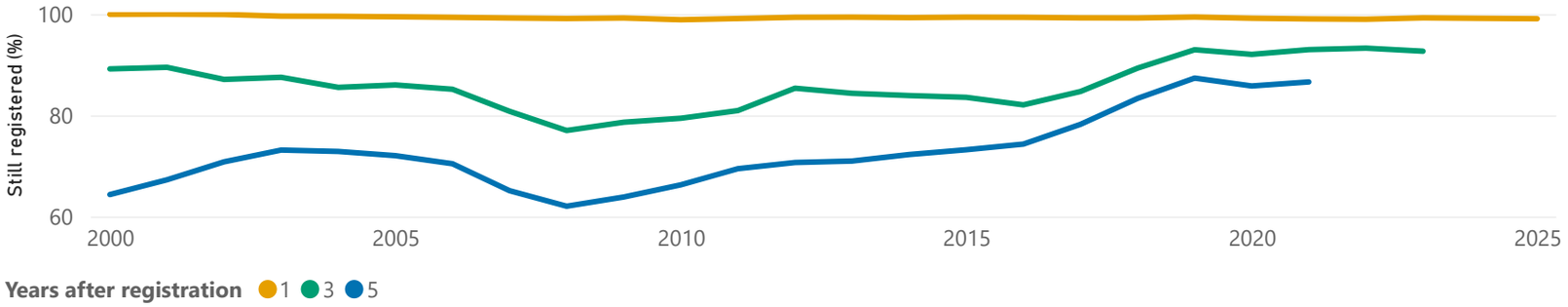
Where and when are companies registered?

This page shows how many companies were registered each year, in which counties, and in which sectors.

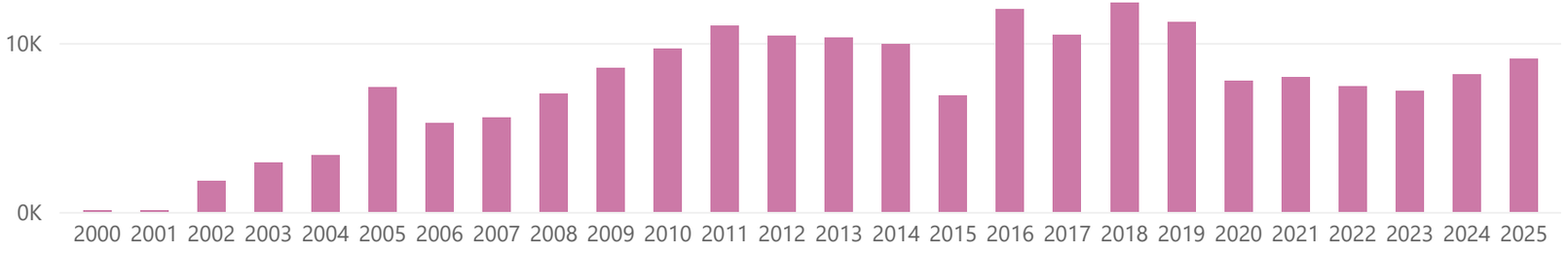
- Registrations ranged from 13,465 in 2009 to 26,533 in 2025. They grew over time, with dips in 2020 and 2022. There is no clear change after the Brexit vote in 2016.
- 44.4% of companies are registered in Dublin, with 227K companies, far more than any other county.
- Since 2016, the largest sector is professional, scientific and technical activities, with 41K companies. Part of this sector is catch-all business codes, so it is likely too large.
- Sector codes are only reliable from 2015, so the sector chart starts in 2016.

Source: CRO Company Records (opendata.cro.ie), CC BY 4.0.

Share still registered 1, 3 and 5 years after registration



Closures per year (companies registered since 2000)



1-year survival
99.3%

3-year survival
86.5%

5-year survival
73.7%

Closed since 2000
206,055

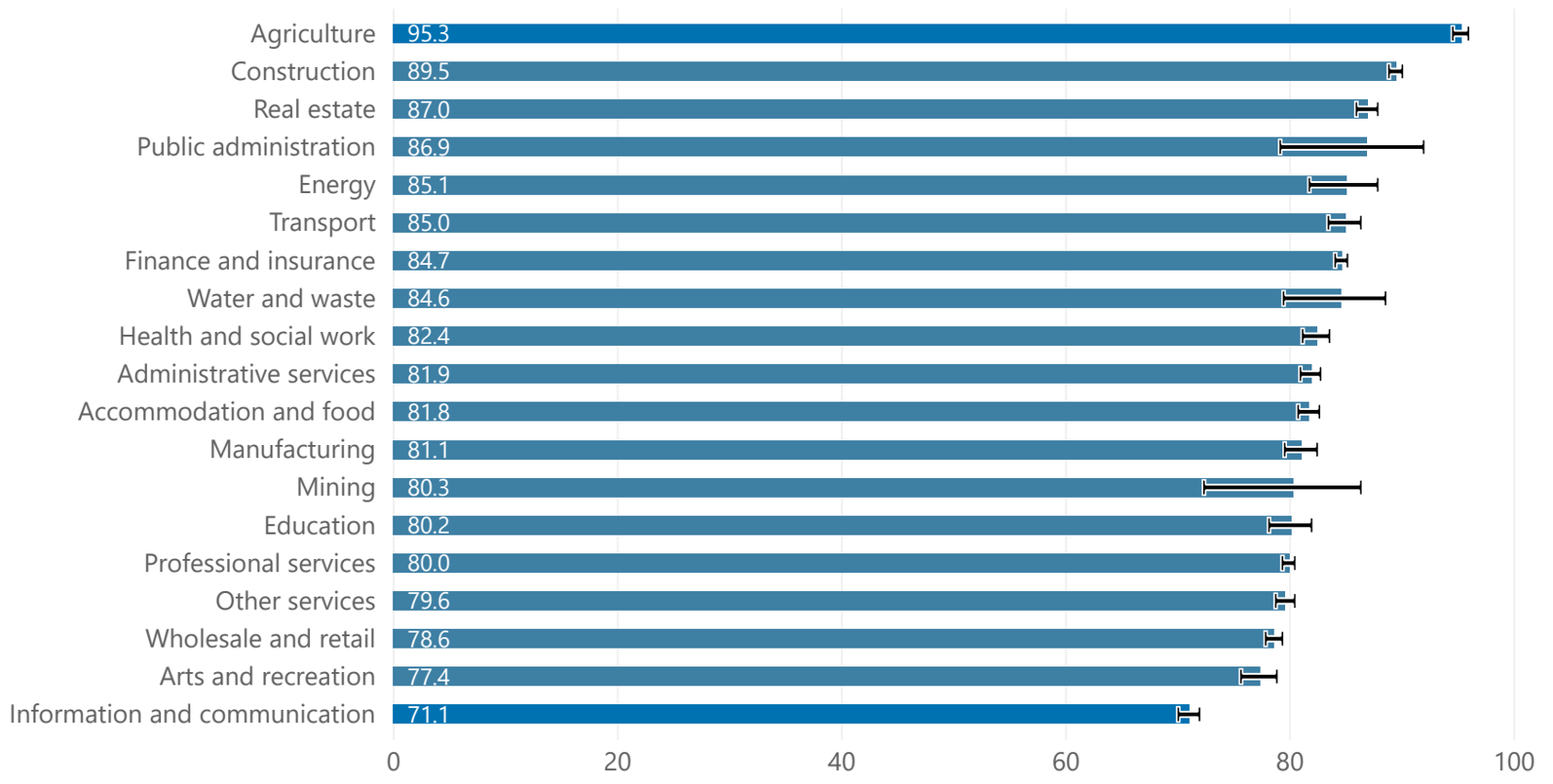
How many new companies are still registered?

This page shows the share of companies still on the register 1, 3 and 5 years after they were registered, and how many closed each year.

- 99.3% of companies are still registered after 1 year, 86.5% after 3 years and 73.7% after 5 years.
- Companies registered around 2008 had the lowest 5-year survival. Companies registered in later years survived much better.
- Closures dropped in 2020, stayed low until 2023, then rose again. Some companies registered in recent years have not been closed yet, so their survival is likely too high.
- The lines end at different years because recent companies have not been registered long enough to be measured.
- 206,055 companies registered since 2000 have closed.

Source: CRO Company Records (opendata.cro.ie), CC BY 4.0.

Share still registered 5 years after registration, by sector



Highest sector

95.3%

Agriculture

Lowest sector

71.1%

Information and communication

Gap between sectors

24.2 points

Highest minus lowest sector

Widest 95% interval

14.0 points

Mining

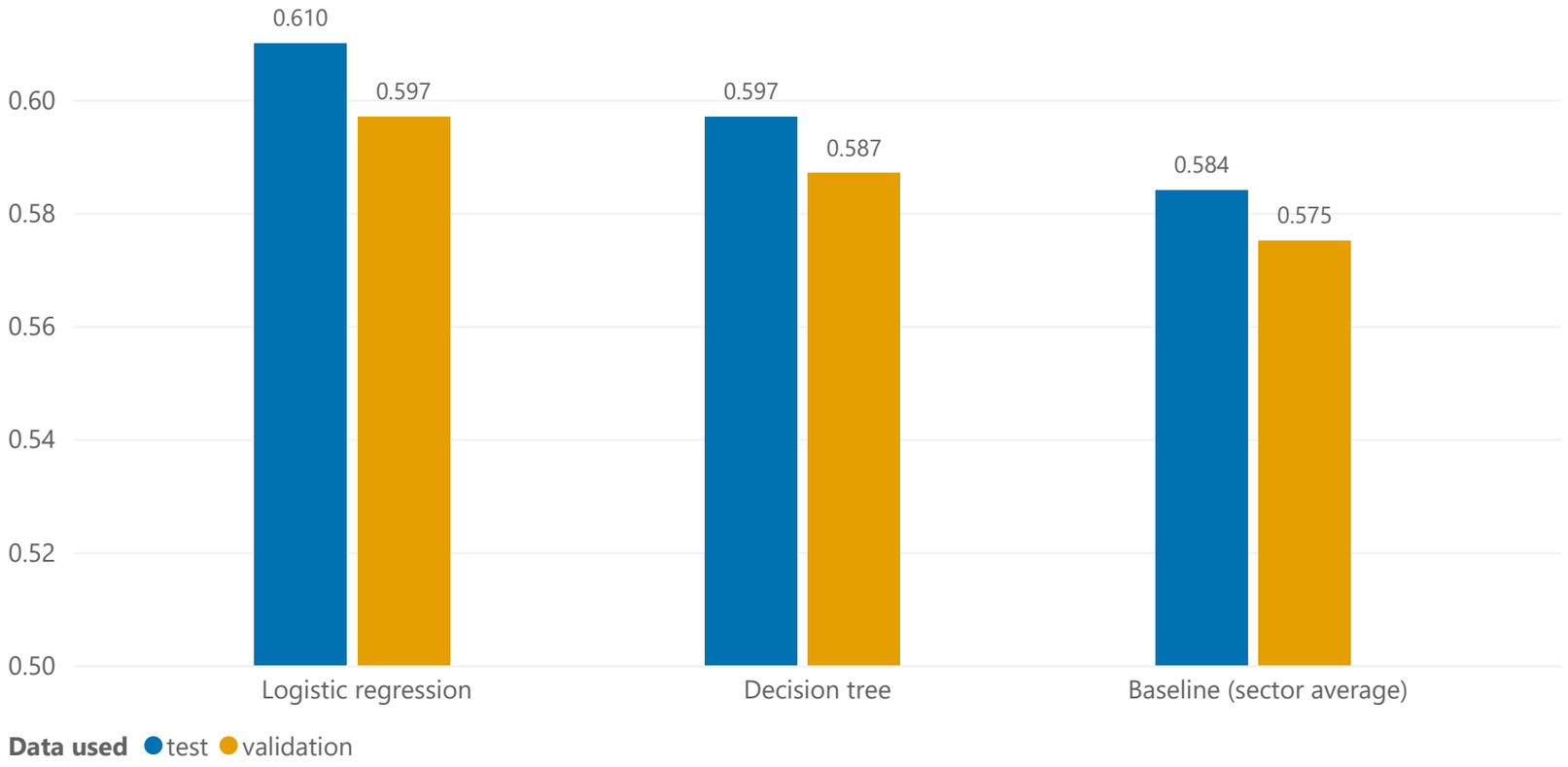
Which sectors survive best?

This page shows the share of companies in each sector still on the register 5 years after they were registered. The black lines are 95% confidence intervals.

- Agriculture has the highest 5-year survival at 95.3%. Information and communication has the lowest at 71.1%, a gap of 24.2 points.
- The top and bottom of the ranking are clear: Agriculture's interval is above every other sector and Information and communication's is below every other sector.
- Many sectors in the middle have overlapping intervals, so their order should not be read too closely. Small sectors have wide intervals. The widest, 14.0 points, is for Mining.
- Only companies registered in years with reliable sector codes and a full 5 years of data are included. Very small sectors are left out.

Source: CRO Company Records (opendata.cro.ie), CC BY 4.0.

How well each model ranks survivors above closures (AUC)



Model AUC (test)	Gain over baseline (test)	Predicted survival (test)	Actual survival (test)
0.610	+0.026	78.6%	86.6%

Can a simple model predict which companies survive?

This page compares three models that predict whether a company is still registered 5 years after registration. AUC shows how well a model ranks companies that survived above companies that closed. 0.5 is no better than chance.

- Logistic regression has the highest AUC on the test companies, 0.610. That is +0.026 better than the baseline, which only uses each sector's average survival.
- The models are in the same order on the validation companies. The model was chosen on validation data, and the test data was used only once.
- The gain over the baseline is small. Sector, area and company type explain only a little of which companies survive.
- The model predicts 78.6% survival for the test companies, but 86.6% survived. It learned from earlier companies, and later companies survived more often, partly because fewer companies were closed after 2020.

Source: CRO Company Records (opendata.cro.ie), CC BY 4.0.